Introduction to International Politics 1601

Levels of Analysis I: Domestic, Bureaucratic, and Organizational Politics. Looking inside the "Black Box"

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Looking Inside the "Black Box"

Recall: Democratic Peace Theory (previous lecture)

- democracies rarely, if ever go to war *with each other*
- norms-driven and structural explanations
- excludes patterns between dem-nondem dyads and democratizing states

Implications:

- **Regime type matters** to system-level outcomes

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- Regime type matters to system-level outcomes
- or, we may need to *open up the "black box"* to study states' propensity for conflict or cooperation

Our level of analysis *thus far*?

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The state.

Additional levels of analysis we introduce when looking inside the "black box" -

- domestic level (or, state/society) individual level (or leadership - next lecture)

Levels of Analysis -

- System
- State
- Individual

Our objective:

- Explain system-level outcomes (may use any level of analysis)

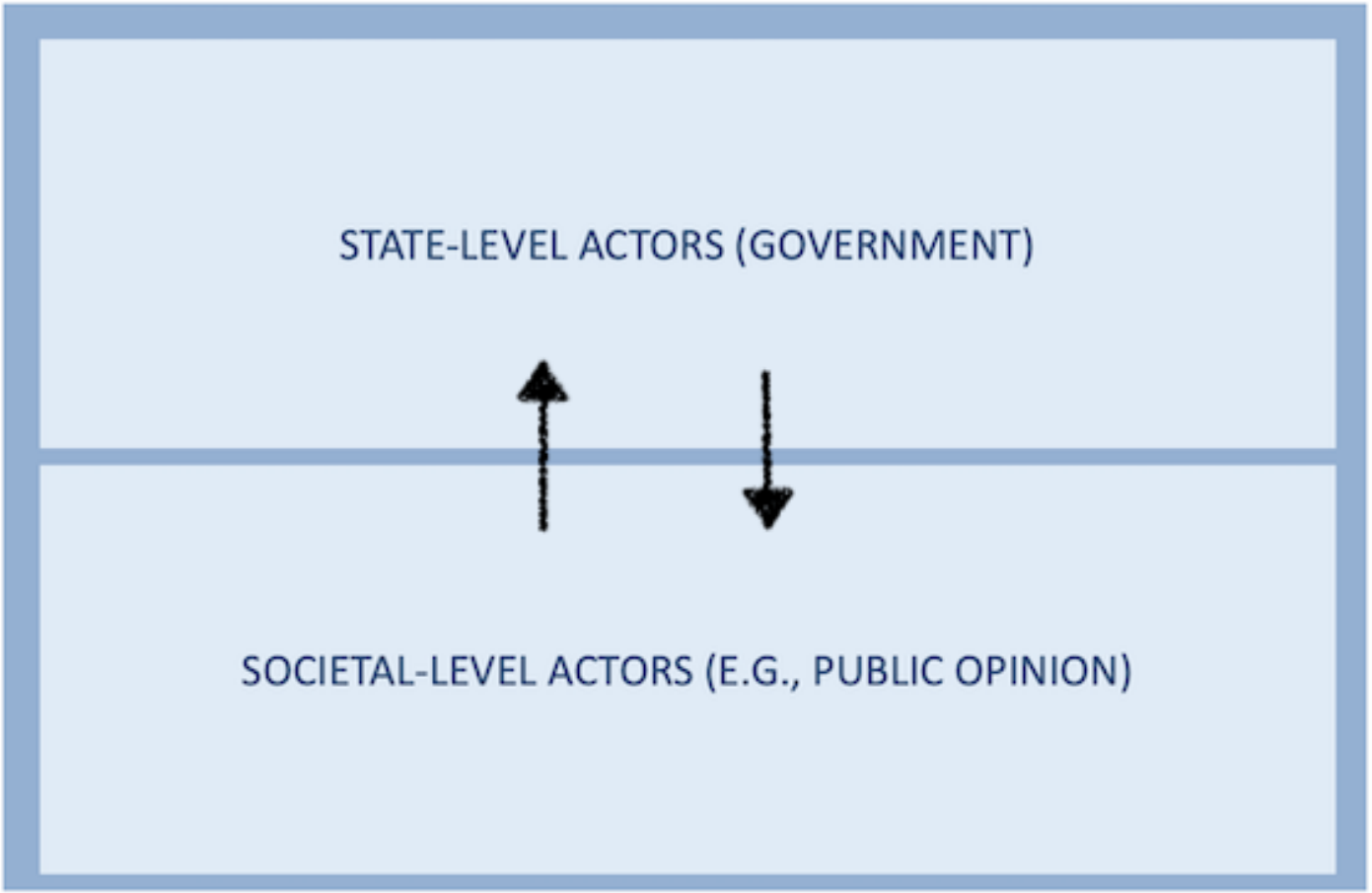
[INSERT COUNTRY
NAME HERE]

Inside "the black box" -

- Other actors (e.g., leaders, economic actors) and structures (i.e., institutions) at the domestic level of politics may contribute to outcomes in international politics.

Domestic Institutions

When we study **domestic institutions**, we consider the dynamics *between the state (the government) and society*.


STATE-LEVEL ACTORS (GOVERNMENT)
SOCIETAL-LEVEL ACTORS (E.G., PUBLIC OPINION)

How does government accountability shape its foreign policy?

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Foreign policy at the state level translates to outcomes at the (international) system level (i.e., policy "filters" through states).

At the domestic institutions level of analysis (i.e., study), we consider other factors which influence states' behaviors in the international system.

Domestic institutions may *motivate or constrain* state's behaviors (thought of as: *choices*).

Example: The Democratic Peace -

- What: democracies rarely if ever go to war with one another
- Why? (Proposed theories) Because leaders are *constrained* by their public's preference for diplomatic approaches to conflict.

The Democratic Peace: Structural Explanation -

- The effects of domestic institutions manifest differently in *democratic* and *authoritarian* regimes.
- States make different choices based on their structural constraints
- System-level outcomes differ between states of these differing regime types

Example: Diversionary Theory (or Diversionary *Motivations For War*)

- Governments may initiate conflict in cases of domestic turmoil in order to generate domestic support (*Rally-'Round-the-Flag* Effect)

Recall: States are *primary* actors -

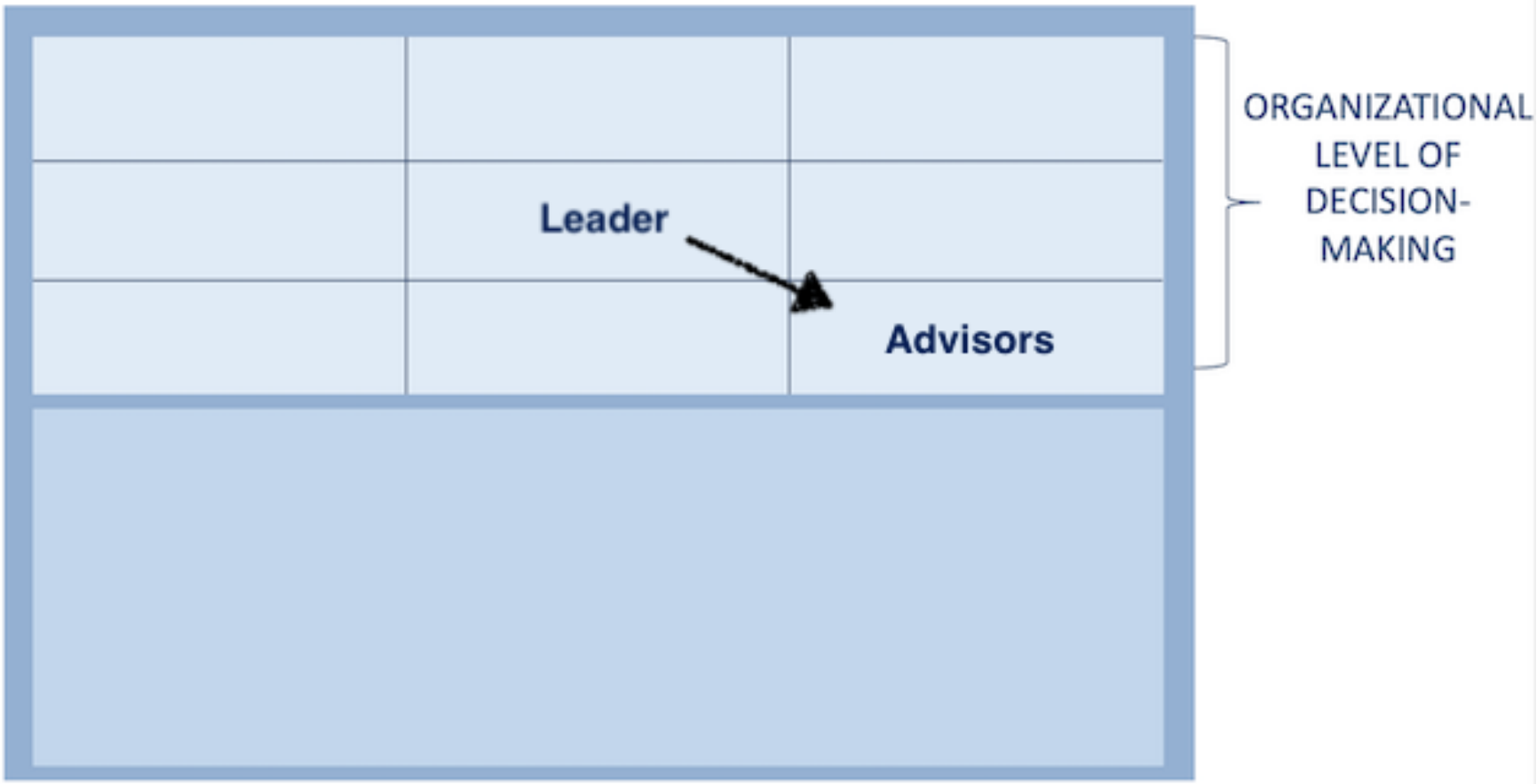
- no longer the *only* actors, but remain primary
- rational, *unitary* actors
- government(/state) is a unitary, rational actor responding to pressures from *within the state* not only outsides of it (i.e., the international system).

Domestic Actors

The **domestic actors** level of analysis looks at additional pressures from *within the government*.

(Our next lecture will consider individual level factors, primarily at the level of leadership).

Actors *within the state* may have further influence on foreign policy decisions than the pressures imposed by traditional institutions.


Leader
Advisors
ORGANIZATIONAL LEVEL OF DECISION-MAKING

Additional decision-making models:

- **The Organizational Model**
- **The Bureaucratic Politics Model**

These models will break up our notion of the state (i.e., government) as a unitary, rational actor.

Additional decision-making models:

- The Organizational Process Model - **non-rational**, unitary
- The Bureaucratic Politics Model - rational, **non-unitary**

The Organizational Process (OP) Model

The OP Model -

- a state's foreign policy is the product of domestic actors' *routines*
- actors within the government follow routines when responding to conflict

Result -

- States' foreign policies are somewhat unitary, but not always rational (non-rational).
- However, foreign policy can be consistent over time.

Consequences -

- satisficing
- uncoordinated foreign policy

Satisficing -

- choosing the *acceptable* policy without considering all optimal policy outcomes

The Bureaucratic Politics (BP) Model

The BP Model -

- a state's foreign policy is the outcome of *internal politics*
- actors within the government can exert greater or lesser influence on a state's foreign policy depending on its relative power within the government
- and actors may also be motivated by organization-based or personal interests. ("Where you stand is where you sit.")

Consequence -

- States' foreign policies may be devised from rational behavior, but are not "unitary"

Next lecture: Levels of Analysis II: The Individual Level of Foreign Policy-making